

Two Voices, One Bridge



Internal Communications and Branding & Outreach: why one group became two, and which voice speaks when.

OWNER: BRANDING & OUTREACH

ONE GROUP BECAME TWO

From its first days on the Bridge, one Communications group carried every word the institute spoke, whether the listener sat inside the community or out in the world. The Codex-to-Structure deck divided that work into two Bridge Groups, because the two audiences ask for different voices. The deck named them Internal Communications and Marketing & Branding; the second is recorded as Branding & Outreach.

"Communication helps us speak with one another. Marketing helps us speak with the world."

That sentence from the deck is the whole dichotomy in miniature. Everything below is elaboration.

INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS • THE INWARD VOICE

The deck's charge, verbatim: "Looks inward: keeps members connected, informed, coordinated, remembered, and aligned as one coherent community." Internal Communications is how the institute remains one organism: newsletters and session recaps, meeting coordination, community memory, and the shared understanding that lets many hands work as one. Its listener already belongs. Michele Atwater leads this group.

BRANDING & OUTREACH • THE OUTWARD VOICE

The deck's charge for the outward group, verbatim: "Looks outward: tells the Luminara story, stewards the public identity, grows visibility, and helps the right people find us." Branding & Outreach is how the world first meets Luminara: the public identity and its rules, the story told in materials and media, and the paths by which the right people find their way in. Its listener does not yet belong, and may decide whether to. The office of Chief Marketing Officer is deliberately held open in the paperwork, so that a future CMO steps into a seat whose brand rules are already law.

WHY THE SPLIT HOLDS THE RAILS

"Bridge holds the rails. Program carries the journey."

The deck gives the Bridge one job: infrastructure that lets light move. Speaking is infrastructure. When one group speaks both inward and outward, the registers blend; community warmth leaks into public claims, and public polish stiffens community life. The split lets each voice keep its own discipline. Inward, the standard is coherence: everyone informed, nobody forgotten. Outward, the standard is fidelity: every public word matching the settled forms, the claims framing, and the identity the board has adopted. The rails hold precisely because the two voices never have to compromise with each other inside a single group.

THE COLORS SAY IT TOO

The two groups wear colors that share a root, and the kinship is deliberate. Internal Communications keeps Radiant Violet (#60508D), carrying the name Drew Stone gave the original Communications group's color. Branding & Outreach wears Beacon Brick (#8F4239). Both carry red: violet tempers it with blue for the voice indoors, brick grounds it in earth for the voice outdoors. They sit a third of the way around the color wheel from each other and at the same lightness, like two oars set at one depth on one boat: each pulls on its own side, and the boat moves only because they pull together.

WHICH VOICE SPEAKS WHEN

THE REQUEST	THE GROUP
Newsletter items, session recaps, community announcements	Internal Communications
Meeting coordination, member records, community memory	Internal Communications
Website, public materials, press, and media	Branding & Outreach
Logo, palette, templates, and the Branding Style Sheet	Branding & Outreach
Public claims review and inquiry framing	Branding & Outreach
Anything unclear	Either; the groups route between themselves

Requests reach each group through the named institute addresses on the Public Contacts sheet.